Elifsu Genç Istanbul, Turkiye

critical designer • interior design & architecture student • level designer

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Manifesto

My practice begins with overlooked experiences and the questions they raise about everyday life. I approach design as a way to examine the assumptions and systems shaping how people perceive, inhabit, and relate to the world. Drawing on philosophy and psychology, I begin by questioning the brief itself: whose perspectives it centers, what it leaves unspoken, and what possibilities it overlooks.

Through research, spatial design, and interactive media, I translate these inquiries into tangible experiences that invite reflection and connection. I explore biomaterials and emerging systems as tools for this work, asking how they can make hidden conditions perceptible and open new ways of seeing, understanding, and engaging with our surroundings.

Education

2019-2022 **Deneyap Türkiye Technology Workshops,** Ankara, Türkiye

Scholar

• Completed training in ***Design and Production, Robotics and Coding, Electronics Programming and the Internet of Things, Advanced Robotics, Software Technologies, and Cybersecurity*** through DENEYAP Technology Workshops.
• Teknofest Finalist 2020 (Autonomous Underwater Systems – Design Team)

2023-2027 **Mef University,** Istanbul, Türkiye

Bachelor's Degree in Interior Design

CGPA:3.96/4.00

• Fully funded scholarship
• Mef Bir Adım Bin Umut Student Club

2023-2024 **Google Game & App Academy**

Scholarship Recipent

• Completed training in coding and game development with ***Unity, game art, game UI/UX, and AI-assisted game development.***
• Game Environment Design and Level Design - Catkeeper (itch.io: egemenazay.itch.io/cat-keeper)

2024-on going **Mef University**

Bachelor's Degree in Architecture

CGPA:3.96/4.00

• Fully funded scholarship

Teaching

2025-2026 Fall Semester **History and Theory of Interior Design I (INT221), Mef University**

Student Assistant

• Assisted with course material preparation and attendance tracking for a second-year History and Theory of Interior Design I course.
• Course Instructor: Assist. Prof. Dr. Ahmet Sezgin

2025-2026 Spring Semester **Introduction to Game Design (DGD101), Mef University**

Student Assistant

• Reviewed and graded assignments for DGD 101: Introduction to Game Design, evaluating student work according to course expectations.
• Course Instructor: Assist. Prof. Dr. (Head of Digital Game Design Department) Kutay Tinç

Internship

2025 Summer **HASKAN Engineering,** Kanyon Shopping Mall, Istanbul, Türkiye

Interior Design Intern

• Contributed to the interior design and implementation of an Intimissimi Uomo store at Kanyon, following the project from initial design development through on-site execution and completion.

2026 Summer **HelsinkiZurich Office,** Helsinki, Finland

Architectural & Interior Design Intern

• Contributed to the interior design and phasing strategy for the competition proposal, producing 3D models, technical drawings, and renders.

Projects

2024 Summer **ara-sıra**

Mef University Design & Build! Studio, Lütfi Banat Primary School, Istanbul, Türkiye
Team Member

• Contirbuted to the design process and construction process of a schoolyard resting and reading area for Lütfi Banat Primary School as part of a first-year design-build studio.
• https://fada.mef.edu.tr/Portfolio/ara-sıra-

2026 - on going **Fire Evacuation Simulation Game Design**

3D Designer - Level Designer

• Research and document how fire reacts to different materials and how it spreads through the school building.
• Analyze the speed and behavior of fire propagation under different conditions.
• Creating a 3D model of the MEF University.
• Implementing a fire spread and evacuation simulation based on the collected data

• Project Instructor: Assist. Prof. Dr. (Head of Digital Game Design Department) Kutay Tinç

2026 - on going **Bajo La Fresca**

Team member

• Developed a proposal to address limited planting space in an existing patio, integrating new growing areas while preserving and highlighting the patio's existing character.

• AA Visiting School Cordoba, MuDD Architects

Awards & Honors

2020 **Teknofest Finalist 2020**
Autonomous Underwater Systems
Design Team

2024 **Mef University Dean's Awards 1st Year Category**
Project: Sprouting Garden
ARC101 1st Year Design Studio

2025 **Mef University Dean's Awards 2nd Year Category**
Project: BIODECAY
INT 202 2nd Year Design Studio

2026 **im2025 National Interior Design Students Awards 2nd Place**
Project: BIODECAY
INT 202 2nd Year Design Studio

2026 **im2025 National Interior Design Students Awards Honorary Mention Award**
Project: STRAY
INT 201 2nd Year Design Studio

Skills

Programs

Graphic Design	Adobe Illustrator, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe InDesign
CAD & 3D Modeling	AutoCAD, Rhinoceros 3D (Rhino), 3ds Max
Parametric Modeling	Grasshopper
Rendering & Visualization	V-Ray, Enscape
Programming	Unity, C++, JavaScript, Git, GitHub

Languages

Turkish (Native)
English (B2–C1)
Chinese (HSK 3)